

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**

-----X
FABIAN JOHNSON,

Plaintiff

- against -

Index No.

Purchased 11-11-2020

Plaintiff designates Bronx
County as the place of trial

The basis of the venue is
where the tort arose

**CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838),**

SUMMONS

Defendants.
-----X

TO THE ABOVE-NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bronx, NY
November 12, 2020



THE LAW OFFICE OF JODI MORALES

Attorney for Plaintiff
888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H
Bronx, NY 10451
(646) 582-0400

Defendant's Address:
CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
BRONX COUNTY**

-----X
FABIAN JOHNSON

Plaintiff,

**Index No.
Verified Complaint**

- against -

**CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838)**

Defendants.

-----X
Plaintiff FABIAN JOHNSON, by his attorney THE LAW OFFICE OF JODI MORALES, by JODI MORALES, principal, complaining of the defendants, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges the following upon information and belief:

PARTIES

1. At all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff FABIAN JOHNSON was a resident of Bronx County, City and State of New York.
2. At all times hereinafter mentioned, defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK ("CITY"), was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. At all times hereinafter mentioned, THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT ("POLICE"), was and is an agency of Defendant CITY.
4. At all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendants, **POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838), (PO CRUZ)** were and still are officers employed by Defendants.

BACKGROUND

5. On April 9, 2019, at approximately 7:24 p.m., inside 1060 Stebbins Avenue in Bronx County, without just cause or provocation, defendants, including **POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838)** unlawfully arrested, restrained, assaulted, battered, imprisoned, humiliated and maliciously prosecuted plaintiff under false charges.
6. On or about April 10, 2019, a criminal complaint was issued at the directive of Defendants and a criminal action against Plaintiff commenced.
7. Plaintiff remained in custody until he was released on or about April 11, 2019.
8. Plaintiff had to defend against false charges until the criminal matter was terminated in Plaintiff's favor on November 27, 2019.

PROCEDURAL POSTURE

9. On March 3, 2020, Plaintiff served a Notice of Claim in writing sworn to on Plaintiff's behalf upon Defendant CITY, by delivering a copy thereof to the officer designated to receive such process personally, which Notice of Claim advised the Defendant of the nature, place, time, and manner in which the claim arose, and the items of damage and injuries sustained so far as was then determinable.
10. More than thirty days have elapsed since service of said notice and defendant CITY has failed to pay or adjust this claim.
11. A 50-H hearing has been held.
12. This action has been commenced within one year and ninety days after the cause of action of Plaintiff accrued.
13. Plaintiff has duly complied with all conditions precedent to the commencement of this action.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION: FALSE IMPRISONMENT

14. Paragraphs 1-13 are incorporated by reference as fully set forth herein.
15. Plaintiff was aware of Plaintiff's arrest and confinement as described in paragraphs 5-7, and Plaintiff did not consent to that arrest or confinement.
16. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and the confinement was not privileged or authorized by any warrant, order, or other legal right.
17. As a result of being falsely imprisoned by the Defendants, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries. Plaintiff was denied liberty and Plaintiff suffered emotional distress, humiliation and fear and intimidation for Plaintiff's safety.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION: MALICIOUS PROSECUTION

18. Paragraphs 1-17 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
19. In arresting Plaintiff, the Defendants acted with malice. The Defendants lacked probable cause to arrest Plaintiff.
20. All charges pending against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed upon the application of the District Attorney on November 27, 2019.
21. As a result of being maliciously prosecuted by the Defendants, Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for Plaintiff's safety.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION: BATTERY

22. Paragraphs 1-21 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
23. When **POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838)** grabbed Plaintiff and arrested Plaintiff, he subjected Plaintiff to a harmful or offensive bodily contact. **POLICE**

OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838) intended to make that contact without the consent of Plaintiff.

24. As a result of being battered by **POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838)** Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION: ASSAULT

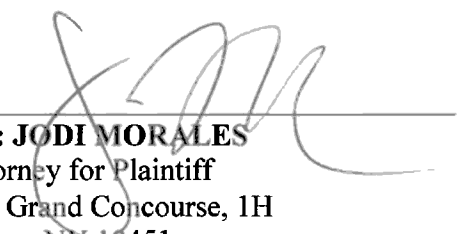
25. Paragraphs 1-24 are incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
26. **POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838)** acting as the agents, servants and employees of the Defendants, placed Plaintiff in apprehension of imminent harmful or offensive contact.
27. As a result of being assaulted by **POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838)** Plaintiff sustained multiple injuries, including emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants, together with the costs and disbursements of this action in the amount of damages greater than the jurisdictional limit of any lower court that would otherwise have jurisdiction, together with attorneys' fees and costs for bringing this case, and punitive damages.

Dated: Bronx, NY
November 12, 2020

Yours, etc.,

THE LAW OFFICE OF JODI MORALES



BY: JODI MORALES

Attorney for Plaintiff

888 Grand Concourse, 1H

Bronx, NY 10451

646-582-0400

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**

-----X
FABIAN JOHNSON,

Index No.

Plaintiff

Purchased: _____

-against-

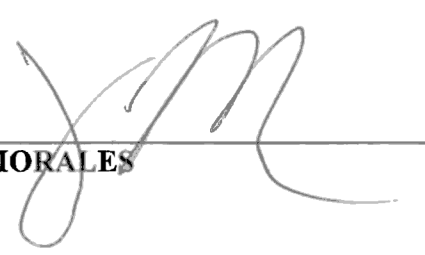
**CITY OF NEW YORK,
POLICE OFFICER PAUL CRUZ (shield #9838),**

Defendants
-----X

I, **JODI MORALES**, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am the attorney of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true.

I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bronx, NY
November 12, 2020



JODI MORALES